

1 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 15 minutes

Torn-paper garden

What we are practising

Choose shapes and arrange them to represent an idea.

What you need

Paper sheet / Coloured scrap paper / Washable non-toxic glue stick

Arrange pieces without glue, or draw the garden.

Before you begin

Set out a few large paper pieces and a base sheet.

Supervise glue use and keep paper and glue away from the mouth; scissors are unnecessary.

Try it together

1. Tear a long strip for a stem and a broad piece for a flower.
2. Arrange pieces before attaching them.
3. Invite the child to add a path or imaginary plant and describe it.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What could grow in your invented garden?

Space to explore

2 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Become a living statue

What we are practising

Express an idea through movement and describe a creative choice.

What you need

No materials

Use hands, facial expressions or a toy instead of whole-body poses.

Before you begin

Clear a small space and choose seated or standing poses.

Keep feet stable and movements gentle; avoid climbing or balancing on furniture.

Try it together

1. Make a tree pose with arms as branches.
2. Invite your child to make a different tree.
3. Choose another idea, such as a sleepy cat, and take turns guessing the pose.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What could your hands show about your tree?

Space to explore

3 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 15 minutes

Texture rubbing pictures

What we are practising

Explore how a surface pattern can become part of a picture.

What you need

Paper / Large unwrapped crayon / Corrugated cardboard

Draw repeated lines if suitable textured surfaces are unavailable.

Before you begin

Place paper over clean cardboard with the ridges facing up.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Hold the paper steady while rubbing the crayon's side across it.
2. Turn the paper and try rubbing in another direction.
3. Use the pattern as part of a drawing, such as a striped animal or roof.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What could these lines become in your picture?

Space to explore

4 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 15 minutes

A paper character with a voice

What we are practising

Combine visual choices with imaginative storytelling.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Use a sock held loosely over an adult's hand.

Before you begin

Fold a sheet once so it can stand like a tent.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Draw a large face or animal on one side.
2. Give it a name and a voice: "Hello, I am Cloud Cat."
3. Let the character ask for something, then answer through a second pretend character.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What does your character like doing?

Space to explore

5 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Kitchen sound composer

What we are practising

Choose and organise contrasting sounds.

What you need

Unbreakable bowl / Wooden spoon / Folded towel

Use finger taps on knees and claps only.

Before you begin

Set the bowl and towel on a stable surface.

Use gentle taps only, keep tools away from faces and stop if sounds are uncomfortable.

Try it together

1. Tap the bowl softly once, then tap the towel.
2. Describe how the sounds differ.
3. Invent a three-sound phrase, repeat it, then let your child change one sound.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which sound would suit a sleepy elephant?

Space to explore

6 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

A circle with a new job

What we are practising

Use added details to give a simple shape a new purpose.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a circle and add travel clues.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A circle is waiting on the page. What could you add to turn it into something that can travel?

Space to explore

7 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

The enormous tiny thing

What we are practising

Notice how changing an object's size changes its possible uses.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a giant button beside a small animal.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Imagine a button as big as a house. What could a toy animal do with it?

Space to explore

8 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

A line becomes a landscape

What we are practising

Build an imagined place around an existing mark.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a zigzag and build a place around it without erasing it.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

You have one long zigzag. What place could grow around it without rubbing the line away?

Space to explore

9 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

A hat for a cloud

What we are practising

Match a playful design to one stated requirement.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a cloud and a hat with a route for rain.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A pretend cloud wants a hat that lets its rain fall. What might the hat look like?

Space to explore

10 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

The dot that starts a journey

What we are practising

Connect imagined places with a path that returns to its start.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a looping journey from a starting dot.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A dot is the start of a beetle's walk. Where could your crayon take it before it comes home?

Space to explore

11 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

A box in pretend play

What we are practising

Communicate a pretend role through gesture and setting.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a box, then use a gesture to give it a pretend role.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Picture an empty box. How could you pretend it is a boat without changing the real box?

Space to explore

12 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

A creature with a useful tail

What we are practising

Invent a body feature that solves a fictional carrying problem.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a creature whose tail helps carry a picture.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

An imaginary creature wants to carry a picture while keeping its hands free. What could its tail do?

Space to explore

13 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

A picture with a hiding place

What we are practising

Use a visible clue to suggest a hidden animal.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a hiding place and one visible clue.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A drawn rabbit wants to hide but leave one clue that it is there. What would you show?

Space to explore

14 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

A quiet picture without blue

What we are practising

Explore how spacing and detail can suggest a quiet mood.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Choose a quiet scene and show it using any available crayon.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Can you draw a place that feels quiet to you without needing a blue crayon?

Space to explore

15 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Wings for an imaginary chair

What we are practising

Use picture clues to show motion in a still drawing.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a flying story chair with visible action clues.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A chair in a silly story can fly. What would you add so the picture tells us it is flying?

Space to explore

16 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

A doorway for a giant

What we are practising

Relate the size of an entrance to the character using it.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a doorway for a giant and show who uses it.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A friendly giant visits a tiny town. How could you draw a doorway that welcomes the giant?

Space to explore

17 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

A name for a made-up colour

What we are practising

Connect an invented name with an imagined quality and setting.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Name an imaginary colour and draw where it belongs.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Imagine a colour nobody has named. What would you call it, and where would it appear in a story?

Space to explore

18 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

The silent puppet greeting

What we are practising

Communicate a greeting without relying on spoken words.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a puppet and act out its silent greeting.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A paper puppet cannot speak in this story. How could it greet a visitor kindly?

Space to explore

19 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

A meal for a story dragon

What we are practising

Combine familiar shapes with imaginary food ideas.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a dragon's three-shape pretend meal.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Your pretend dragon eats shapes instead of food. What three-shape meal would you draw for it?

Space to explore

20 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

The missing sound in a story

What we are practising

Choose a gentle sound that gives a clue about a place.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a door and choose a gentle sound for the place behind it.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A drawn door opens onto a pretend forest. What gentle sound could tell us what is behind it?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Torn-paper garden

A little hint

Turn a paper piece around to discover a new shape.

Answer / what to notice

Any arrangement representing the child's garden works; plants may be imaginary.

Tearing and rearranging allow shapes to change during making.

Make it easier

An adult tears large pieces; the child chooses positions.

Take it further

Add two kinds of plants with different shapes.

Another day, away from the screen

Tell a short story about who visits the garden.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. Become a living statue

A little hint

Think about tall, drooping, wide or windy branches.

Answer / what to notice

Different poses may represent the same idea; explain the chosen feature.

An idea can be communicated with gesture as well as words.

Make it easier

Copy one adult pose.

Take it further

Change a calm tree into a windy tree using only one movement.

Another day, away from the screen

Use a pose to describe a character in a story.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Texture rubbing pictures

A little hint

Press gently and use the crayon's long side.

Answer / what to notice

Visible lines or patches are useful results; the child decides what they represent.

Raised parts underneath receive more rubbing pressure and create a pattern.

Make it easier

Hold the paper for the child.

Take it further

Combine two rubbing directions in one picture.

Another day, away from the screen

Look for another large, clean textured surface to try.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. A paper character with a voice

A little hint

Offer a familiar wish, such as finding a friend or taking a nap.

Answer / what to notice

The child chooses the character and conversation; no realistic drawing is required.

A name, a wish and a voice can turn a simple picture into a story character.

Make it easier

An adult draws while the child chooses features.

Take it further

Give two characters different wishes and invent how they agree.

Another day, away from the screen

Use the character to retell a favourite event.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Kitchen sound composer

A little hint

Try gentle, slow sounds before quicker ones.

Answer / what to notice

Any gentle sound sequence is acceptable; a repeated phrase can form a tiny composition.

Different surfaces vibrate differently, creating different sounds.

Make it easier

Copy two sounds made by the adult.

Take it further

Make two short phrases and choose an ending.

Another day, away from the screen

Add your sounds to a made-up animal story.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

6. A circle with a new job

A little hint

Think about something that rolls, flies or sails.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I add two wheels and a window to make a round bus. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Added details can give the same simple shape a new meaning.

Make it easier

Choose between a wheeled car and a flying balloon.

Take it further

Give your invention a place to carry a passenger.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

7. The enormous tiny thing

A little hint

Look at the holes and the round edge.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: A mouse could use a button hole as a tunnel. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Changing scale can create a new use for a familiar object.

Make it easier

An adult draws the button; choose what the animal does.

Take it further

Add a second animal using another part differently.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

8. A line becomes a landscape

A little hint

Could the line be a road, mountains or a river?

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I add clouds above it and make the zigzag a mountain range. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Keeping an existing mark encourages you to build on what is already there.

Make it easier

Choose a mountain or a road for the line.

Take it further

Tell what happens at one bend.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

9. A hat for a cloud

A little hint

Show where the raindrops can pass.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: It could have wide holes, like an imaginary umbrella with openings. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A design can be playful while still meeting a stated need.

Make it easier

Point to where an adult should draw a hole.

Take it further

Change the hat so two clouds can share it.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

10. The dot that starts a journey

A little hint

Choose one stop and a way back.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: My line visits a leaf, circles a stone and returns to the dot. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A drawn path can connect imagined places into a journey.

Make it easier

Visit just one place before returning.

Take it further

Add a stop where the beetle changes direction.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

11. A box in pretend play

A little hint

What action would someone in a boat make?

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I draw waves around its picture and pretend to paddle. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Gesture and setting can transform an object in pretend play.

Make it easier

Copy a gentle paddling gesture while seated.

Take it further

Invent another role for the same drawn box.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

12. A creature with a useful tail

A little hint

Think about curling, balancing or making a little shelf.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: A curled tail could hold the rolled picture like a loop. Other reasoned ideas can work.

An invented body feature can solve an imagined practical problem.

Make it easier

Choose a curled tail or a flat tail.

Take it further

Show how the creature gives the picture to a friend.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

13. A picture with a hiding place

A little hint

Which rabbit feature is easy to recognise?

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I draw a bush with two rabbit ears peeking above it. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A small visible part can suggest something larger that is hidden.

Make it easier

Let an adult draw the bush and add the ears.

Take it further

Hide a second animal with a different clue.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

14. A quiet picture without blue

A little hint

What would you leave out of a busy picture?

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I draw one resting cat, gentle lines and plenty of empty space. Other reasoned ideas can work.

People can suggest a mood through arrangement and detail, not one required colour.

Make it easier

Draw one resting character.

Take it further

Make another quiet picture with a different animal or setting.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

15. Wings for an imaginary chair

A little hint

Show something above or below the chair.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I draw wings, clouds below it and little movement lines behind it. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Context and movement marks help a still picture suggest action.

Make it easier

Add just wings to an adult's chair drawing.

Take it further

Show where the chair lands at the end.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

16. A doorway for a giant

A little hint

Compare the doorway with the giant's shoulders.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I make a tall wide doorway and draw the giant beside it to show the size. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Comparing a design with its user helps explain why its size matters.

Make it easier

An adult draws two door sizes; choose which gives the giant enough room.

Take it further

Add a smaller entrance for tiny neighbours.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

17. A name for a made-up colour

A little hint

Combine a feeling, sound or familiar object with your name.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I call it giggle-glow; it shines on a laughing moon in my story. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Invented names can connect an imagined quality with a story idea.

Make it easier

Choose one invented name offered by an adult.

Take it further

Describe the colour without using an existing colour word.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

18. The silent puppet greeting

A little hint

Think of a gesture the visitor can see.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: It could wave and hold up a picture of a welcoming smile. Other reasoned ideas can work.

An action or picture can communicate a message without spoken words.

Make it easier

Choose a wave or a nod.

Take it further

Invent a silent goodbye that looks different.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

19. A meal for a story dragon

A little hint

Choose shapes first, then invent their food names.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I draw a circle soup, triangle toast and a square berry. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Giving familiar things unusual properties creates playful combinations.

Make it easier

Use one shape and give it a food name.

Take it further

Make a menu that shows the dragon's favourite first.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

20. The missing sound in a story

A little hint

You may name the sound instead of making it.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I make a soft bird chirp to suggest birds in the trees. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A chosen sound can give a listener a clue about an unseen place.

Make it easier

Choose birdsong or soft rain from two spoken options.

Take it further

Change the setting and choose a new sound clue.

Another day, away from the screen

Keep your drawing and ask a partner to invent a different solution to the same question.